

With the markets in chaos, a GOP pushback

Some Republicans in Congress want to limit the president’s ability to impose tariffs on other countries.

By FAITH E. PINHO

WASHINGTON — As the fallout over President Trump’s tariffs continues to roil the world economy, a few Republicans in Congress have begun discussing how to curb the president’s ability to levy tariffs — taking a rare step to rein in the party leader.

Republican leaders have largely struck a “wait-and-see” attitude toward the tariffs, as well as with their continued effect on the plunging stock market and negative consumer sentiment. House Speaker Mike Johnson told reporters Monday that Congress would “weigh in on it, but with the president, with the administration in tandem.”

“I think you’ve got to give the president the latitude, the runway to do what it is he was elected to do, and that is to get the economy going again and get our trade properly balanced with other countries,” Johnson said.

But others in Congress — including a couple of California Republicans — don’t want to wait.

Sen. Chuck Grassley (R-Iowa) introduced a bill last week, alongside Sen. Maria Cantwell (D-Wash.) and other lawmakers of both parties, to reassert Congress’ authority and limit the president’s power over trade policy. The Trade Review Act of 2025 would require the president to notify Congress of any new tariffs within 48 hours, and to provide analysis and reason for their purpose. It also would allow Congress 60 days to review the tax.

“I’ve long expressed my view that congress has delegated too much authority on trade to the executive branch under Republican & Democrat presidents,” Grassley posted on X.

Rep. Don Bacon (R-Neb.) said Sunday that he would introduce a companion bill in the House, so it could advance in both chambers.

Already, several Republican lawmakers — including California Rep. David Valadao, a Hanford Republican who holds the precarious



Washington Post

A PAUSE IN WRONGFUL DEPORTATION CASE

Jennifer Vasquez Sura, left, whose husband, Kilmar Abrego Garcia, was deported to El Salvador, is hugged by a supporter. The Supreme Court paused a judge’s order demanding his return. **NATION, A4**

California schools scramble as more foreign students lose visas

Discovery of other affected campuses stokes confusion and concern

By JAWEED KALEEM

Confusion and concern have ratcheted up at California colleges as campus officials indicated they were caught unaware by the Trump administration’s cancellation late last week of dozens of international student visas.

Federal authorities have revoked at least 83 foreign

student visas within the University of California and California State University systems and at Stanford, college officials said.

UCLA confirmed Sunday that federal authorities revoked the visas of 12 community members: six current students and six recent graduates. In a campus message, Chancellor Julio Frenk implied the government had not notified UCLA

ahead of time. The issues were found during a “routine audit” of an immigrant student database connected to the Department of Homeland Security, he said. The government had shifted students’ status and canceled their visas from the State Department.

“The termination notices indicate that all terminations were due to violations of the terms of the individu-

als’ visa programs,” Frenk said in his campus message. “At this time, UCLA is not aware of any federal law enforcement activity on campus related to these terminations.”

He later told the campus: “We recognize that these actions can bring feelings of tremendous uncertainty and anxiety to our community. We want our immigrant

[See Students, A5]

When pot investments go up in smoke

Brash, Porsche-driving entrepreneur behind a cannabis shop in Hollywood is accused of fraud in lawsuits.

By NOAH GOLDBERG

To investors, Vincent Mehdizadeh pitched himself as a rags-to-riches Los Angeles success story — a man whose family fled religious fundamentalism in Iran and who later grew up to transform the legal cannabis industry through technology.



AMANDA VILLEGAS For The Times

VINCENT MEHDIZADEH calls himself an “avid” founder of Pineapple Express. He denies wrongdoing.

As the founder of Medbox, a company that pioneered the use of biometric sensors in pot vending machines, Mehdizadeh wrote that he had “pushed the conversation about cannabis, an amazing wonder plant, into the mainstream public’s psyche.”

So, when the brash, Porsche-driving weed entrepreneur announced he was advising several partners in the creation of a chain of swank cannabis shops dubbed “Pineapple Express,” investors such as Grammy-winning rapper Tauheed K. Epps, or 2

[See Cannabis, A10]



Beyond The Call

DEFENDER OF FREEDOM WWII veteran Sgt. Joe Harris was a pioneering member of the Army’s first all-Black paratrooper battalion.

SGT. JOE HARRIS, 1916 - 2025

Paratrooper who served in World War II

Compton resident was a member of the all-Black ‘Triple Nickles’ battalion.

By NATHAN SOLIS

Sgt. Joe Harris lived a beautiful life. He sailed to earth on numerous missions as a member of the U.S. Army’s first all-Black paratrooper battalion during World War II, the 555th, aptly nicknamed the “Triple Nickles.”

At his funeral service on Sat-

urday, friends, family and uniformed members of the military danced and sang to honor Harris, believed to be the oldest paratrooper veteran when he died March 15.

He was 108.

“He was a kind, caring, compassionate man,” his daughter La Tan-ya Pittman told The Times. “He didn’t let the fact that he was fighting for freedom during segregated times stop him from living his life.”

Harris, who was born in Westdale, La., on June 19, 1916, died in a Los Angeles hospital surrounded by family. He lay in repose Saturday at Lewis Metropolitan CME

Church.

Many cried, but they also laughed, as the service felt like a homecoming — one last leap for Harris into the unknown.

His grandson, Ashton Pittman, thanked his grandfather for all that he sacrificed.

“He was our rock, the foundation among which generations have been built,” he said.

Harris received full military honors and was interred at Inglewood Park Cemetery.

His funeral procession included a World War II Willys Jeep escort, and a military aircraft flew over the

[See Paratrooper, A5]

Trump says he won’t bend on tariffs

The president gives no sign of a rapid course correction and threatens even stiffer levies on China.

By MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — Mixed messages on trade from the Trump administration threw markets into further turbulence on Monday, leaving investors, foreign governments and the president’s own allies desperate for an off-ramp from a dramatic increase in global tariffs scheduled to go into effect Tuesday night.

Yet President Trump, posting on social media and speaking to reporters throughout the day, gave no indication he was open to a rapid course correction, suggesting some of his new tariff rates — set at a baseline of 10% for all countries, but increasing substantially for some of the largest U.S. trading partners — would be permanent. Other rates, he said, might be the subject of bilateral negotiations without any guarantee of success that could take weeks, months or even years.

The mere rumor that Trump would consider a pause in the policy led to a fleeting rally on Wall Street, only for stocks to plummet again on word from the White House that the suggestion was “fake news.” The day of confusion led the Dow Jones industrial average and Standard & Poor’s 500 to post moderate losses at the closing bell, with the Nasdaq up a fraction of a point.

From the Oval Office, Trump said he would escalate an emerging trade war with China after Beijing said it would respond to a new U.S. tariff rate of 34% with an identical tariff hike of its own. In response, Trump said, he would add another 50% tariff increase on Chinese imports — a move that would result in Chinese products facing 104% import duties by Wednesday.

[See Trump, A7]

A milestone in schools’ rebuild

Campuses burned in Palisades fire are ahead of schedule in debris cleanup. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Dodgers feted at White House

The club is welcomed by Trump and lauded for 2024 World Series title in a traditional ceremony. **SPORTS, B10**

Yo-Yo Ma plays with LAUSD

Cellist joins “Last Repair Shop” pupils to raise cash for district’s 130,000 instruments. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Weather Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 77/54. **B6**

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